

woes bore him. He is thinking about how he is going to spend his next bonus. That is why people stay in the debt collection profession – the money. They don't believe they are saving the world economy, or doing a noble deed. They like their income, plain and simple.

Debt collection is a multibillion-dollar industry. The debt collectors don't care one iota about you or your situation. Your circumstances do not matter to them. To them, you are just another hard-luck story, and all they care about is the scoreboard hanging over their cubicle. You will get their attention only when you are able to talk money.

So let's talk money.

A Cure

Damian and Martina had fallen on hard times when Damian's business crashed. They were still able to make the house payment, the car payment, and the orthodontics bill for their daughter's braces, but money was very tight. Martina's salary had allowed them to get by, barely, but they were falling behind on the credit card bills. Every day, a new statement came in the mail, the fees were growing, and they were feeling overwhelmed, like most debt-riddled people.

Damian and Martina had a lawyer friend help them draft their balance sheet and income statement. They gathered all their documentation, showing their original bills and all the fees that had compounded since Damian's business went under. Some creditors they contacted directly to work out a settlement on those debts. For the others, they worked with the collection agency. They reduced their overall debts by 50%! They were able to borrow from Martina's father and mother, who will allow them to pay back the debt when they get back on their feet. What had seemed like an insurmountable crisis was handled by calmly implementing the *Debt Cures* solutions.

Net Worth

Once you learn it is a numbers game, you have to play the numbers too. Even if you are getting calls from a collection agency, you can still contact the original creditor. If they have not sold off your debt, they may be willing to work with you. Tell them your story, but show them